



Watch Dogs Review

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In Watch Dogs, you play criminal and vigilante extraordinaire, Aiden Pearce, a computer hacker who is also strangely adept at kicking ass, shooting guns and being generally grumpy in the grand tradition of white male protagonists. After a hacking operation gone wrong, Pearce is hunted by killers who murder his niece and leave him more pissed off than usual. And that's where the game begins. In the mould of Splinter Cell: Conviction another game starring an angry white guy on a revenge trip, Watch Dogs starts off with you torturing/beating up a suspect. However soon after, you are thrown into the bustling real world city of Chicago as you begin your search for the people that you hold responsible for your misery.

The Gameplay

When Watch Dogs was first shown off at E3 2012, it kinda blew everyone's mind.

Hacking appeared to be a core gameplay element that was not only innovative but looked like it would let gamers use other methods than combat to achieve objectives. Hacking primarily lets you do three things – profile passers by and steal from their bank accounts, peek at their messages or calls or see if they're likely to be the victim of a crime or the perpetrator of one; hack into cameras and security locks; and control city infrastructure while driving to help you defeat enemies or get away from cops.

Profiling is the feature that was the focus of most of the pre-launch hype that



Watch Dogs has you play Aiden Pearce, white male action hero variant #6335

surrounded Watch Dogs and it's also the most disappointing. While it's neat for the first hour or so to see the profiles of bystanders pop up with intimate details, there's really no point to it. In fact, you'll probably end up switching off the 'Profiling' feature unless the game absolutely requires you to turn it on. Hacking into cameras is much, much cooler since you can chain hacks by pointing a camera at another one to see (or hack into) something that's far away from you. This also comes into play very effectively when you have a room full of bad guys and you can thin the crowd from a safe distance by simply hacking into cameras and then using them to set off explosives, electrical boards etc.

Hacking while driving is an essential component but it could also have been more effective and fun. You can change traffic lights, bring up barriers and bridges on the fly but most of it barely does a thing to affect your pursuers.

Apart from hacking and driving, Watch Dogs also has you taking down groups of